

Sociology 310: Sociological Research Methods

Fall 2026 Sections 004 & 005

Meetings:

Section 004: Fridays, 11 a.m. – 12 p.m., USB 1160

Section 005: Fridays, 12 p.m. – 1 p.m., MH 2462

GSI: Peng, Haorui (彭浩瑞)

Office Hours:

Fridays, 1 p.m. – 3 p.m., or by appointment, LSA 4253

If possible, schedule in advance at <https://calendar.app.google/c7e57xYUbHvzZ8Av9>

Email: haoruiiii@umich.edu

Section Materials:

Canvas page of our course, under [Files/Sections](#)

An alternative link: <https://haoruiiii.github.io/teachings/en-us/fa26-soc-310/>

Discussion Section Overview

Section Goals and Structure

The main goals of the discussion sections are to 1). apply course material to designing and conducting a research project, 2). provide guidance as you develop your own research project and paper, and 3). discuss key methodological concepts and techniques. The discussion section provides a space for you to ask questions about course materials, learn from your peers via groups work, and participate in collective learning.

To facilitate these goals, there will be workshopping weeks and lecturing weeks. In the workshopping weeks, you will spend most of the time working in groups to complete the upcoming assignment(s), which will serve as an important part of your final paper. I will be there to answer your questions and give a helping hand when you struggle. In the lecturing weeks, we will go through the major theme(s) covered in the week and focus on concepts and/or techniques on which you still have confusions, aiming to increase the clarity. I will organize class activities, if necessary, for these weeks.

Attendance & Participation

Section participation is **mandatory**, and your weekly attendance & participation at discussion sections make up 12.5% of your overall grade for this course. As described above, sections are where you will solidify your understanding of key concepts and techniques and learn how to work through the kinds of problems you will encounter on class assignments. Discussion sections will provide multiple ways for you to be an active participant, and participation may consist of contributing to group discussions or pair shares, completing in-class exercises, and active listening.

Section Grading and Requirements

Your section participation grade (again, 12.5% of the total) will be determined by active participation and respectful participation in discussions.

a). *Active Participation* is required and involves attending every discussion section during the semester, unless you have an excused absence. Because Professor Boutyline designs this class to be very structured and every assignment serves as a significant scaffolding of your group project, the quality of your final paper is likely negatively impacted if you miss one or more of the discussions. Therefore, I do *not* grant free unexcused absences. If you have a planned absence, please inform me via email (preferably 48 hours) in advance and include any relevant documentation. If you have an unplanned absence, such as those due to illness, inform me via email, preferably within 24 hours of our discussion sections and no later than 12 p.m. ET of the following Monday. Any absences not documented by email will be considered unexcused, which will result in a deduction of your section grade. Having said such strict requirements, though, I do understand that life happens and you may face various kinds of issues and/or challenges. If, because of these, you cannot make it to our sections, please email me and let me (Prof. Boutyline as well, if necessary) know! Again, preferably in advance to our scheduled section time but no later than noon the following Monday. Remember that the key is communication – if you let me know and we figure out a plan to make up your absence, you are likely having an excused absence for that day.

b). *Respectful Participation* means to remain engaged in class discussions and activities throughout the entire section period. It includes but is not limited to respectfully listen while others are speaking, to significantly contribute to in-class activities, and to participate in full-class discussions. Everyone has a unique perspective on the course material and has something to contribute. I also understand that different students have different preferences on when, where, and how they speak up, so your engagement is *not* based on how many times you speak or whether you provide “the right answer.” Therefore, if it works better for you, you are more than welcomed and encouraged to participate in class discussions by talking to me during office hours and/or emailing me your thoughts/questions.

Illness Policy

If you are sick and unable to attend discussion sections, you must contact me via email to receive an excused absence. If you have more than two of such absences due to illness, you must talk to me and we figure out a plan for you to stay on the same page with your peers, especially your group mates.

Section Logistics

Communication Expectations

Email is the most effective way of communication between us. Email is also a nice way to ask simple and specific questions. For broader questions and/or concerns about the materials

and assignments, I would highly recommend that you come to my office hours (and Professor Boutyline's, of course, if helpful). My regular office hour slots are listed at the top of this syllabus. Regarding emails, there are three things –

a). Please **start your subject with “SOC 310” in any email to me**, so that they are not marked as spam or otherwise lost. I appreciate it if you also specify your section number in the email, which helps me a lot!

b). I will check emails regularly on weekdays from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. and will try my best to reply in two days. For example, if you email me on Tuesday, I will likely respond by Thursday. Any emails sent out of these regular hours (especially on weekends) will be addressed during the next business day or otherwise within the designated two-day period.

c). I usually use the “schedule send” function of Gmail so that you will receive my reply in the morning of a business day. However, if you get something from me (an email or an announcement) out of my regular business hours, it just means that I accidentally fail to use the function. It does not mean that I expect you to work after regular hours. Study-life balance is very important, and I do respect everyone's!

Also, if I have announcements for you, I will use the Canvas announcement function. Please **ensure that your notifications are turned on** so that you do not miss them!

Office Hours

I encourage all of you to attend office hours throughout the semester, not just before assignment due dates. Office hours are a time and space allocated to help you succeed in the course. We can discuss *a variety of things* during this time, such as questions about specific course concepts, assignments, or discussion prompts; general confusions, frustrations, or anxieties; ideas, inspirations, and epiphanies; or your student experience and future academic and professional goals.

My regular office hours are scheduled for **Fridays from 1 to 3 p.m.**, right after our discussion sections, in Room 4253 of the LSA building. I generally divide the two hours into 20-minute slots. I highly recommend that you make an appointment to reserve one slot in advance via this link, <https://calendar.app.google/c7e57xYUbHvzZ8Av9>, which also helps me be better prepared for your visit. It is also acceptable to just drop by, but you may need to wait for the scheduled appointments to wrap up. Walk-in appointments will be first come, first served, and will also be around 20 minutes. I would also suggest that you visit in person, although meeting via Zoom is also available (the information is in the scheduling link). If you cannot make it to my regular office hours, please email me so that we can find some time working for you.

Please also note that the two discussions I lead and my office hours slots are back-to-back, and I need to move from USB to Mason Hall then to LSA within 10 minutes. Therefore, I am likely unable to talk to you after class, unless you walk with me to my next stop. If you have short, simple questions, you may email me; otherwise, I suggest that you come to my office hours!

Tentative Schedule

Week #	Date	Type	Content / Focus
1	Sept. 4	<i>No Section – We start next week</i>	
2	Sept. 11	Workshopping	Introductions; Research Question + Literature Review
3	Sept. 18	Lecturing	Variables
4	Sept. 25	Workshopping	Variables
5	Oct. 2	Lecturing	Interviews and Surveys
6	Oct. 9	Workshopping	Instrument
7	Oct. 16	Workshopping	Sampling Plan
8	Oct. 23	Workshopping	Pilot Data Collection
9	Oct. 30	Lecturing	Qualitative Data Analysis
10	Nov. 6	Lecturing	Quantitative Data Analysis
11	Nov. 13	Lecturing	Quantitative Data Analysis, continued
12	Nov. 20	Workshopping	Writing the Results
13	Nov. 27	<i>No Section – Thanksgiving Break</i>	
14	Dec. 4	Workshopping	Final Paper
15	Dec. 11	<i>Scheduled for students' presentations</i>	

Additional Information

Academic Misconduct

Plagiarism on any assignment or cheating on an exam, including improper use of generative Artificial Intelligence, on which I apply the same standard as the main instructor, is absolutely forbidden and will result in a failing grade on the assignment and a referral to the LSA Office of the Assistant Dean for Undergraduate Education. For more information, including examples of behaviors considered academic misconduct and potential sanctions, see [this page](#). If I suspect any actions of plagiarism or cheating, I will immediately report them.

University Resources

The University of Michigan has many resources for students.

- [Sweetland Writing Center](#), whose support specifically for undergraduate students are [here](#)
- [English Language Institute](#), whose [studios](#) for writing (and speaking) are very helpful
- [Center for the Education of Women+](#), for emergency funding, commuter student resources, study space, and counseling
- [Student Legal Services](#)
- [Trotter Multicultural Center](#), [Spectrum Center](#), [Undocumented Students website](#), and the [First Gen Students website](#) hosts resources, readings, and events for additional learning and peer affinity
- [University of Michigan Student Well-Being Resource](#)

- Student resources such as those for disability services, counseling and mental health, emergency funds, diversity and equity, and student complaints may be found [here](#)

Mental Health and Wellbeing

The University of Michigan is committed to advancing the mental health and wellbeing of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of support, services are available. For help, contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at (734) 764 8312 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or through its counselor physically located in schools on both Central and North Campus. You can visit [this page](#) for more information.

Accommodations

The University of Michigan is committed to providing equal opportunity for participation in all classes, programs, services, and activities. Requests for accommodations by persons with disabilities may be made by contracting the Services for Students with Disabilities (SSD) Office located at G664 Haven Hall. The SSD phone number is (734) 763 3000. Once your eligibility for an accommodation has been determined, you will be issued a verified individual services accommodation (VISA) form.

Sexual Misconduct Reporting

Title IX prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex, which includes sexual misconduct – including harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking. I understand that sexual violence can undermine your academic success, and I encourage anyone dealing with sexual misconduct to talk to someone about their experience, so that they can get the support they need. Confidential support and academic advocacy can be found with the Sexual Assault Prevention and Awareness Center (SAPAC) on their 24-hour crisis line, (734) 936 3333 and at [this page](#). Alleged violations can be non-confidentially reported to the Equity, Civil Rights, and Title IX Office.

Some university employees have sexual misconduct reporting obligations and are therefore required to report suspected sexual misconduct of which they learn to the Office for Institutional Equity at the university (see the policy [here](#)). I, as a Graduate Student Instructor (GSI), do *not* have these obligations; I will respect your wishes for how you would like me to treat any disclosures. In general, I will treat them as confidential unless you explicitly tell me otherwise.

Life Events

Life events, such as personal or family crises, happen. If you are experiencing such an event, **please do not hesitate to let me and/or our main instructor know as soon as possible**, so that we can figure out a plan for your ongoing success in the course.